

The Implementation of the caption package^{*}

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Abstract

The caption package consists of two parts – the kernel (`caption3.sty`) and the main package (`caption.sty`).

The kernel provides all the user commands and internal macros which are necessary for typesetting captions and setting parameters regarding these. While the standard L^AT_EX document classes provides an internal command called `\@makecaption` and no options to control its behavior (except the vertical skips above and below the caption itself), we provide similar commands called `\caption@make` and `\caption@@make`, but with a lot of options which can be selected with `\captionsetup`. Loading the kernel part do not change the output of a L^AT_EX document – it just provides functionality which can be used by L^AT_EX 2_ε packages which typesets captions, like the caption package and the subfig package.

The caption package itself redefines the L^AT_EX commands `\caption`, `\@caption`, and `\@makecaption` and maps the latter one to `\caption@@make`, giving the user the possibility to control the look & feel of the captions from floating environments like `figure` and `table`. Furthermore it does similar to the caption stuff coming from other packages (like the `longtable` or `supertabular` package): Mapping the appropriate internal commands (like `\LT@makecaption` or `\ST@caption`) to the ones offered by the `caption3` kernel. So you can think of the caption package as a layer package, it simply provides adaptation layers between the caption stuff coming from L^AT_EX 2_ε itself or L^AT_EX 2_ε packages, and the caption stuff offered by the `caption3` kernel.

User manuals

This document is describing the code implementation only. The user documentation can be found in

caption-eng.pdf	The English documentation
caption-rus.pdf	The Russian documentation ¹
caption-deu.pdf	The German documentation

^{*}This package has version number v3.1, last revised 2007/09/01.

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